

QMS-007 — Risk Register and Management Framework

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This framework establishes how Overleaf Publishers Ltd identifies, assesses, treats, monitors, and reviews risks across all areas of the business — encompassing quality, health and safety, information security, and business continuity. It ensures that the organisation proactively manages uncertainty and protects its ability to achieve its objectives. Document reference: QMS-007.

2. RISK MANAGEMENT PRINCIPLES

- Risk management is integrated into all business processes and decision-making, not treated as a separate activity.
- Risks are identified from all relevant sources: internal and external context; stakeholder requirements; incident and near-miss records; audit findings; management review; and environmental scanning.
- Both threats (negative risks) and opportunities (positive risks) are considered.
- Risk treatment is proportionate to the level of risk and the organisation's risk tolerance.
- Risk owners are accountable for the implementation and effectiveness of risk treatments.
- The Risk Register is a living document, reviewed continuously and formally at each management review.

3. RISK ASSESSMENT METHODOLOGY

Risks are assessed using a 5×5 likelihood × consequence matrix:

SCORE / LIKELIHOOD	CONSEQUENCE
1 — Rare (unlikely in any given year)	Negligible — minimal impact; no regulatory implication
2 — Unlikely (possible but not expected)	Minor — limited impact; manageable without disruption
3 — Possible (could occur in some circumstances)	Moderate — significant impact; some disruption; possible regulatory notice
4 — Likely (will probably occur in most circumstances)	Major — serious impact; significant disruption; regulatory sanction possible
5 — Almost certain (expected to occur)	Catastrophic — business-threatening; regulatory prosecution; significant data breach

Risk Rating = Likelihood × Consequence. Bands: Low 1–4 (green); Medium 5–12 (amber); High 13–18 (red); Critical 19–25 (black). High and Critical risks require Director review and immediate action. Medium risks require a documented treatment plan. Low risks are monitored and reviewed annually.

4. RISK TREATMENT OPTIONS

TREATMENT	DESCRIPTION
Avoid	Eliminate the activity or condition giving rise to the risk
Reduce / Mitigate	Implement controls to reduce likelihood or consequence to an acceptable level
Transfer	Transfer risk to a third party (e.g. insurance, contract terms, supplier SLAs)
Accept	Acknowledge residual risk where it is within tolerance and further treatment is not reasonably practicable
Exploit (opportunity)	Take deliberate action to increase the likelihood of a positive risk/opportunity materialising

5. RISK REGISTER — CURRENT RISK SUMMARY

RISK (L×C = RATING)	TREATMENT / CONTROLS
Inaccurate/outdated course content !' unsafe practice (2×5 = 10 Medium)	Annual SME content audit; rapid correction procedure; IIRSM IV review cycle
Personal data breach — learner records (2×4 = 8 Medium)	Encryption at rest and in transit; access controls; MFA; Data Breach Response Procedure
Platform availability failure — hosting outage (2×4 = 8 Medium)	Business Continuity Plan; offsite backups; RTO/RPO targets; Replit SLA monitoring
Regulatory non-compliance — IIRSM/ RoSPA/ICO (2×4 = 8 Medium)	Compliance calendar; annual internal audit; management review; legal adviser retainer
Sole director incapacity — key person dependency (2×4 = 8 Medium)	Emergency succession instructions; BCP; documented access procedures for nominated contact
Learner misuses course as substitute for practical NPTC assessment (3×4 = 12 Medium)	Digital waiver; prominent practical training disclaimer throughout platform
Third-party supplier failure — Vimeo/Replit (2×3 = 6 Medium)	Supplier evaluation; BCP; fallback procedures; platform diversification where feasible
DSE-related musculoskeletal injury — staff (2×2 = 4 Low)	Annual workstation self-assessment; breaks guidance; ergonomics provision
Intellectual property infringement claim (1×4 = 4 Low)	Content originality review; source attribution; legal adviser review
Fraudulent chargebacks — financial loss (2×2 = 4 Low)	Device locking; activation code controls; clear terms and conditions



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Competitor replicates course content (2×2 = 4 Low)	Copyright notice; dynamic video watermarking; DMCA/UK copyright enforcement
Supply chain disruption to physical manual (1×2 = 2 Low)	Multiple approved printers; print-on-demand capability; digital-only access option

6. RISK REVIEW AND ESCALATION

The Risk Register is reviewed: continuously by the Director for emerging risks; quarterly for medium risks; annually for all risks as part of the management review process. New risks identified between formal reviews are added to the Register immediately and their treatment plan developed within 10 working days. Critical risks are escalated to the Director immediately on identification and addressed without delay.

7. INTEGRATION WITH OTHER MANAGEMENT SYSTEM ELEMENTS

The Risk Register is integrated with: the Nonconformance Register (risks arising from NCs); the Incident Register (risks identified through incident investigation); the Internal Audit Programme (audit scope informed by risk profile); the Supplier Evaluation process (supplier risk assessment); and the Management Review (risk review as a standing agenda item).

8. FRAMEWORK REVIEW

This framework is reviewed annually as part of the management review. The Risk Register is a controlled document held under reference QMS-007.

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